Answers and talk notes

Math is Ours

What your student is learning

Tonight we name our problem-solving process: make sense of the problem, choose a representation, make a plan, check progress, and change strategy when stuck.

Answers

Ask your student to explain before you look.

1. **C.** Make sense of what the problem is asking. Make sense of what the problem is asking comes first, before you choose a plan.
2. **A.** 12. 6 bikes with 2 wheels each is 6 × 2 = 12 wheels.
3. **D.** Try a smaller number or draw a picture. Try a smaller number or draw a picture. Both give you a new way to see the problem.
4. **B.** 36. 4 shelves with 9 cans each is 4 × 9 = 36 cans.
5. **C.** 70. 5 times as many as 14 is 14 × 5 = 70 wheels.
6. **A.** 60 is 4 groups of 15, so it should be bigger than 15. 60 is 4 groups of 15, so it should be bigger than 15. It also works to check that 15 + 15 + 15 + 15 = 60.

Talk about it

What did you do first to make sense of the problem, and what could you try if you got stuck?

Home mission

Set out 8 forks to be bikes. Give each fork 2 coins for wheels. Ask your student to say what the problem asks, then show the 16 wheels. Last, ask what your student could try next if the problem got hard.

When they are stuck, ask

- What is the problem asking, in your own words?
- What could you draw to see it?
- What is one thing you could try next?

Try not to say

- Here, let me just do it for you.
- You should already know this.
- There is only one right way to solve it.